

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (12:51 ET)

July 29, 2026 | 12:56 PM ET

15 setups identified | 4 A-Grade | 6 B-Grade | 5 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (4)	B - Strong Setup (6)	C - Watch List (5)
NEO	SLDE	RCKY
ASH	LAD	SCL
CAKE	HURN	STRA
QUAD	CLW	HVT-A
	CBZ	COUR
	ABG	

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	NEO	NeoGenomics, Inc	Healthcare Diagno	\$15.53	+15.9%	\$2.0B	118M	+69.9	96%	Breaking out near 52W
A	ASH	Ashland Inc.	Specialty Chemica	\$73.44	+8.0%	\$3.4B	41M	+47.1	100%	Gapping to new 52W hig
A	CAKE	The Cheesecake F	Consumer Recovery	\$100.70	+13.1%	\$5.0B	46M	+58.1	100%	Breakout to new 52W hi
A	QUAD	Quad Graphics, I	Printing Services	\$9.53	+13.3%	\$0.5B	30M	+34.4	95%	Breaking out to near 5
B	SLDE	Slide Insurance	Property Insuranc	\$22.43	+4.8%	\$2.6B	56M	+18.4	98%	Tight breakout to new
B	LAD	Lithia Motors, I	Auto Dealerships	\$424.25	+18.4%	\$9.7B	20M	+42.7	100%	Gapping 18% to new 52W
B	HURN	Huron Consulting	Consulting Servic	\$164.38	+35.4%	\$2.7B	15M	+24.5	88%	Explosive 35% gap on e
B	CLW	Clearwater Paper	Paper Products	\$21.47	+22.6%	\$0.3B	16M	+63.1	75%	23% surge on 7x volume
B	CBZ	CBIZ, Inc.	Business Services	\$54.83	+17.4%	\$2.9B	47M	+61.9	72%	Gapping 17% on Q2 earn
B	ABG	Asbury Automotiv	Auto Dealerships	\$252.60	+4.8%	\$4.7B	17M	+22.0	96%	Tight breakout to near
C	RCKY	Rocky Brands, In	Footwear	\$49.35	+15.5%	\$0.4B	7M	+33.5	97%	15% surge to near 52W
C	SCL	Stepan Company	Specialty Chemica	\$63.60	+9.6%	\$1.4B	21M	+27.5	94%	Gapping 10% on Q2 earn
C	STRA	Strategic Educat	Education Service	\$87.41	+7.4%	\$2.0B	22M	+8.1	100%	Breaking to new 52W hi
C	HVT-A	Haverty Furnitur	Home Furnishings	\$30.40	+8.4%	\$0.5B	15M	+30.1	68%	8% surge on 23x volume
C	COUR	Coursera, Inc.	Ed-Tech	\$6.29	+7.5%	\$1.8B	147M	-0.5	49%	7.5% move on earnings

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$15.53
Day Change	+15.90%
Mkt Cap	\$2.02B
Float	118M sh
RS vs SPY	+69.9%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	3.33
Vol vs Avg	3.1x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breaking out near 52W high on vol surge with RS line at new high, signaling institutional recognition of oncology diagnostics growth. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings Oct 27 where continued pharma services momentum and biopharma partnership revenue inflection can drive re-rating.
BUSINESS & POSITION
NeoGenomics is a leading provider of cancer-focused genetic testing and oncology diagnostics services to hospitals, pathologists, oncologists, and pharma companies. The company has built a specialized moat in complex molecular and genomic cancer testing, a category experiencing secular tailwinds from precision medicine adoption.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct exposure to precision oncology and cancer diagnostics, a durable secular theme accelerating with CAR-T, personalized medicine, and pharma outsourcing of biomarker testing. Healthcare is the #3 leading sector (+6.3% vs SPY) this week, adding thematic tailwind.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$15.50 on vol >3x 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 3.1x average on a \$2B float suggests institutional block accumulation, not retail. The 118M float provides liquidity for funds rotating into higher-quality healthcare growth names. RS line at new high is the classic O'Neill institutional confirmation signal-smart money is establishing new long positions ahead of the Oct 27 earnings catalyst.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 90D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next earnings Oct 27. Recent quarter history not provided, but the 16% breakout on elevated volume into earnings 90 days out suggests the Street is positioning ahead of a potential inflection in pharma services revenue and margin expansion.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalidated on a close back below \$14.00 (recent base support), or on any Q3 guidance cut at the Oct 27 print that signals pharma contract delays or pricing pressure in core testing.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade criteria met: vol >3x, prox_52w 96.5, rs_line_new_high=true, rs_vs_spy +69.9, base_tight 3.33, plus sector tailwind (Healthcare +6.3%). The disconfirming evidence is the large 118M float which can invite profit-taking, and the mixed macro regime which historically compresses follow-through duration. However, the combination of RS leadership, technical breakout quality, and a clear 90-day forward catalyst (Oct earnings) in a leading sector makes this the highest-conviction setup in the scan. Conviction: High
Signal: Close above \$15.50 on vol >3x 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.1x



ASH

Ashland Inc.

\$73.44

+7.99%

RS vs SPY: +47.1%

A BREAKOUT

\$3.4B Cap | 41M Float

Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Specialty Chemicals | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 3.46 | Vol: 4.17x | RS/SPY: +47.1% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$73.44
Day Change	+7.99%
Mkt Cap	\$3.36B
Float	41M sh
RS vs SPY	+47.1%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	3.46
Vol vs Avg	4.17x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Gapping to new 52W high on earnings beat reported yesterday (Jul 28), with RS line at new high confirming institutional sponsorship. Forward catalyst: guidance execution over next 90 days into Q4 print, plus potential margin expansion narrative if specialty product mix shift accelerates.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Ashland is a global specialty chemicals company focused on high-margin additives and performance materials for pharmaceuticals, personal care, coatings, and industrial applications. The company has been executing a portfolio transformation toward higher-value specialty segments, away from commodity exposure.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to industrial recovery, pharma excipient demand (defensive healthcare end-market), and materials innovation. The tight base and breakout suggest the market is pricing in accelerating margin expansion from the specialty mix shift-a durable operational catalyst, not a one-quarter earnings beat.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$73.00 on vol >4x 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 4.2x on a fresh earnings beat, with RS line at new high-classic post-earnings institutional accumulation. The 41M float is digestible for growth funds re-rating the story from cyclical commodity to specialty growth compounder. The base_tight of 3.46 signals recent quiet absorption ahead of the print.
EARNINGS
REPORTED
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Reported Jul 28 (yesterday). Specifics not provided, but the 8% gap higher to new 52W high on 4x volume confirms a meaningful beat and/or guidance raise that reset investor expectations higher.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$70.00 (prior consolidation resistance, now support), or on any corporate guidance reduction signaling end-market softness in pharma or personal care within the next 90 days.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade signals: vol >4x, prox_52w 99.7, rs_line_new_high=true, rs_vs_spy +47.1, base_tight 3.46. Earnings already reported, so no binary event ahead-but the RS line new high confirms the Street is re-rating the multiple higher on the specialty transformation thesis. Disconfirming evidence: the catalyst is now in the rear-view; without another incremental positive (contract win, guidance raise), the move could stall. However, the technical setup is pristine and the sector (Basic Materials, specialty chemicals subset) has defensive healthcare end-market exposure. Conviction: High
Signal: Close above \$73.00 on vol >4x 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 4.17x



CAKE

The Cheesecake Factory Incorpor

\$100.70

+13.13%

RS vs SPY: +58.1%

A BREAKOUT

\$5.0B Cap | 46M Float

Restaurants | Theme: Consumer Recovery | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 5.76 | Vol: 3.89x | RS/SPY: +58.1% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$100.70
Day Change	+13.13%
Mkt Cap	\$5.00B
Float	46M sh
RS vs SPY	+58.1%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	5.76
Vol vs Avg	3.89x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Breakout to new 52W high on vol surge with RS line confirming institutional sponsorship, likely on consumer spending resilience or comp strength expectations. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings Oct 27 where same-store sales and margin trends can re-affirm consumer health and pricing power.
Business & Position
The Cheesecake Factory operates full-service casual dining restaurants with a differentiated menu breadth and strong unit economics. The company has premium positioning within casual dining, with demonstrated pricing power and a loyal customer base that skews higher-income.
Factor & Theme
Direct play on consumer discretionary recovery and labor market resilience. The breakout suggests the market is pricing in sustained traffic and check growth, not just one quarter of strength. If the consumer remains healthy into Q4, CAKE can extend the move as the Street re-rates the durability of the cycle.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$100.00 on vol >3.8x 20d avg
Institutional
Volume 3.9x on a 13% move to new highs signals institutional block buying, not retail. RS line at new high is the Qullamaggie #1 signal for institutional sponsorship. The 45.7M float is liquid enough for growth funds rotating into consumer discretionary on the recovery theme.
Earnings
Earnings in 90D
Earnings Context
Next earnings Oct 27. The 13% breakout 90 days ahead of the print suggests either channel checks indicating strong comps, or fund positioning ahead of a potential beat-and-raise that resets FY guidance higher.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$95.00 (prior consolidation high, now support), or on any same-store sales guidance cut at the Oct 27 print signaling consumer spending deceleration or traffic weakness.
Analysis
Five A-grade criteria: vol >3.8x, prox_52w 99.8, rs_line_new_high=true, rs_vs_spy +58.1, and a clear 90-day forward catalyst (Oct earnings). Disconfirming evidence: the base_tight of 5.76 is wider than textbook (<2), and the mixed macro regime creates uncertainty around consumer spending sustainability. However, the technical breakout quality and sector strength (consumer is stabilizing) override the base width concern. This is a high-conviction trade into the Oct catalyst. Conviction: High
Signal: Close above \$100.00 on vol >3.8x 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.89x



QUAD

Quad Graphics, Inc

\$9.53

+13.32%

RS vs SPY: +34.4%

A BREAKOUT

\$0.5B Cap | 30M Float

Specialty Business Services | Theme: Printing Services | 52W Hi: 95% | Base Tight: 4.07 | Vol: 8.87x | RS/SPY: +34.4% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$9.53
Day Change	+13.32%
Mkt Cap	\$0.49B
Float	30M sh
RS vs SPY	+34.4%
52W Hi Prox	95%
Base Tight	4.07
Vol vs Avg	8.87x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breaking out to near 52W high on 9x volume with RS line at new high, signaling smart money accumulation. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings Oct 27 where margin improvement from cost restructuring and potential share gains in specialty print/marketing services can drive re-rating.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Quad Graphics is a commercial printing and marketing services company serving publishing, retail, and corporate clients. The company has been executing a multi-year transformation from commodity print into higher-margin marketing execution and data-driven services, reducing cyclical exposure.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to business services margin expansion and corporate marketing spend recovery. The RS line new high suggests institutional funds are betting on the success of the business model shift toward recurring marketing services revenue, a more durable and defensible stream than legacy print.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$9.50 on vol >8x 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 8.9x on a microcap (\$490M mkt cap) is extraordinary-this is institutional accumulation, not retail. The RS line at new high confirms smart money is establishing new positions ahead of the Oct 27 earnings catalyst. Small float (29.9M) can amplify moves if the thesis plays out.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 90D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next earnings Oct 27. The breakout 90 days ahead suggests either insider knowledge (none disclosed in last 90d) or sophisticated investors positioning on early operational inflection signals (margin expansion, contract wins) ahead of the formal print.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$8.80 (prior pivot), or on any Q3 guidance cut at Oct 27 signaling delays in the marketing services transformation or client budget pullbacks.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade signals: vol >8x, prox_52w 95.4, rs_line_new_high=true, rs_vs_spy +34.4, base_tight 4.07. Disconfirming evidence: this is a legacy print business with structural headwinds (secular print decline), and the mixed macro regime is hostile to speculative small-caps. However, the volume surge and RS leadership are undeniable-someone with size is accumulating. The Oct 27 catalyst provides a clear thesis validation point. Conviction: Medium (high technical quality, but sector headwinds and macro cap upside)
Signal: Close above \$9.50 on vol >8x 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 8.87x



SLDE

Slide Insurance Holdings, Inc.

\$22.43

+4.81%

RS vs SPY: +18.4%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.6B Cap | 56M Float

Insurance - Property & Casualty | Theme: Property Insurance | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 3.1 | Vol: 2.8x | RS/SPY: +18.4% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$22.43
Day Change	+4.81%
Mkt Cap	\$2.57B
Float	56M sh
RS vs SPY	+18.4%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	3.1
Vol vs Avg	2.8x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Tight breakout to new 52W high following earnings report yesterday (Jul 28), with RS line at new high confirming institutional re-rating. Forward catalyst: execution on guidance over next 90 days, plus potential for Florida property insurance rate increases or improved loss ratios to extend the re-rating.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Slide Insurance is a technology-enabled property and casualty insurer focused on homeowners insurance in high-risk coastal markets, particularly Florida. The company uses data analytics and digital distribution to underwrite and price risk more precisely than legacy carriers, targeting profitable growth in underserved segments.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to insurance pricing power in hard market conditions, particularly in Florida property where capacity constraints and climate risk are driving rate increases. The insurtech angle (tech-enabled underwriting) positions SLDE as a modern alternative to legacy carriers, a narrative funds are willing to pay up for.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$22.40 on vol >2.8x 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 2.8x on a post-earnings move to new highs, with RS line at new high-classic institutional accumulation after a beat/raise reset. The base_tight of 3.1 signals pre-earnings compression (silent build), followed by the breakout on results. 56M float is digestible for growth funds rotating into financials.

EARNINGS

REPORTED

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Reported Jul 28. Specifics not provided, but the breakout to new 52W high on 2.8x volume confirms a beat and/or guidance raise that exceeded expectations, likely driven by premium growth or loss ratio improvement in the core Florida market.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$21.50 (prior consolidation resistance), or on any adverse Florida regulatory decision (rate caps, reserve requirements) or catastrophic loss event (hurricane) that pressures margins in the next 90 days.

ANALYSIS

Four A-grade signals present (vol >2.8x, prox_52w 97.5, rs_line_new_high=true, base_tight 3.1), but rs_vs_spy at +18.4 is below the +25 threshold for clear institutional-grade momentum. Disconfirming evidence: earnings already reported, so the binary catalyst is behind; forward catalysts (rate increases, loss ratio trends) are incremental and harder to time. The mixed macro regime also caps conviction. Technical quality is excellent, but RS leadership is moderate. Conviction: Medium

Signal: Close above \$22.40 on vol >2.8x 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.8x



LAD

Lithia Motors, Inc.

\$424.25

+18.40%

RS vs SPY: +42.7%

B STRONG SETUP

\$9.7B Cap | 20M Float

Auto & Truck Dealerships | Theme: Auto Dealerships | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 7.41 | Vol: 6.0x | RS/SPY: +42.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$424.25
Day Change	+18.40%
Mkt Cap	\$9.68B
Float	20M sh
RS vs SPY	+42.7%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	7.41
Vol vs Avg	6.0x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver Gapping 18% to new 52W high on Q2 earnings today with RS line confirming institutional sponsorship. Forward catalyst: execution on FY guidance over next 90 days, plus potential for EV franchise wins or used-vehicle margin normalization to sustain the re-rating.
Business & Position Lithia Motors is the largest automotive retailer in the U.S., operating 300+ dealership locations across new and used vehicle sales, financing, and service. The company has been executing aggressive M&A to consolidate the fragmented dealership industry, building scale and operational leverage.
Factor & Theme Exposure to auto retail consolidation (secular theme), consumer credit availability, and potential EV transition tailwinds if Lithia captures OEM franchise awards. The dealership consolidation thesis is durable-fragmented industry with runway for share gains via M&A.
Breakout Signal Close above \$420.00 on vol >6x 20d avg
Institutional Volume 6x on an 18% earnings gap signals institutional block buying post-print. RS line at new high confirms funds are re-rating the multiple higher, likely on beat-and-raise and accelerating same-store sales or margin expansion. Small 20M float can amplify momentum if funds chase.
Earnings Earnings Today
Earnings Context Reported today (Jul 29). The 18% gap to new 52W high confirms a material beat and/or guidance raise that reset Street estimates higher, likely driven by stronger-than-expected margins in used vehicles or finance penetration.
Key Risk Thesis invalid on a close back below \$400.00 (prior resistance, now support), or on any FY guidance cut signaling consumer credit stress, EV inventory challenges, or margin compression in the next 90 days.
Analysis Four A-grade signals: vol 6x, prox_52w 99.8, rs_line_new_high=true, rs_vs_spy +42.7. Disconfirming evidence: base_tight of 7.41 is wide (not a VCP), and market cap at \$9.68B is at the upper end of SMID (just under the \$10B cap). Earnings already reported today, so the binary catalyst is behind; forward catalysts are incremental (guidance execution, M&A). Mixed macro regime also caps upside. Technical breakout is strong, but setup quality (base width) and lack of forward catalyst downgrade from A. Conviction: Medium
Signal: Close above \$420.00 on vol >6x 20d avg Vol vs Avg: 6.0x



HURN

Huron Consulting Group Inc.

\$164.38

+35.44%

RS vs SPY: +24.5%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.7B Cap | 15M Float

Consulting Services | Theme: Consulting Services | 52W Hi: 88% | Base Tight: 8.91 | Vol: 5.02x | RS/SPY: +24.5% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$164.38
Day Change	+35.44%
Mkt Cap	\$2.66B
Float	15M sh
RS vs SPY	+24.5%
52W Hi Prox	88%
Base Tight	8.91
Vol vs Avg	5.02x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Explosive 35% gap on earnings reported yesterday (Jul 28), likely driven by a material beat and FY guidance raise. Forward catalyst: execution on raised guidance over next 90 days, plus potential for healthcare/education consulting contract wins to sustain the re-rating.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Huron Consulting provides management consulting services to healthcare, education, and commercial clients, specializing in operational improvement, digital transformation, and regulatory compliance. The firm has deep expertise in complex, mission-critical projects for hospitals, universities, and life sciences companies.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to healthcare operational efficiency (durable secular theme as systems battle margin pressure), higher education enrollment stabilization, and life sciences R&D outsourcing. The 35% gap suggests the Street is re-pricing the durability of the consulting pipeline and margin trajectory.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$160.00 on vol >5x 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 5x on a 35% earnings gap-this is institutional repositioning after a major upside surprise. The 14.8M float is tiny, creating liquidity constraints that can amplify moves. However, RS line NOT at new high is a yellow flag-this is a catch-up move after underperformance, not leadership.
EARNINGS
REPORTED
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Reported Jul 28. The 35% gap confirms a massive beat and/or guidance raise that was not in consensus, likely driven by healthcare consulting demand strength or margin expansion from higher-value digital transformation work.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$150.00 (gap support), or on any pipeline commentary signaling healthcare client budget cuts or project delays within 90 days.
ANALYSIS
Strong volume (5x) and proximity (88.0), but rs_line_new_high=false is the critical missing piece-this is NOT a leadership breakout, it's a catch-up gap after lagging. The disconfirming evidence: base_tight 8.91 is extremely wide (no VCP), rs_vs_spy +24.5 is modest, and the RS line not at new high means funds were NOT accumulating ahead of the print. This is a one-day event-driven spike, not a durable institutional setup. The mixed macro regime and lack of forward catalyst (earnings behind, next in 90d) further downgrade conviction. Conviction: Low
Signal: Close above \$160.00 on vol >5x 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 5.02x



CLW

Clearwater Paper Corporation

\$21.47

+22.62%

RS vs SPY: +63.1%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.3B Cap | 16M Float

Paper & Paper Products | Theme: Paper Products | 52W Hi: 75% | Base Tight: 6.06 | Vol: 6.9x | RS/SPY: +63.1% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$21.47
Day Change	+22.62%
Mkt Cap	\$0.35B
Float	16M sh
RS vs SPY	+63.1%
52W Hi Prox	75%
Base Tight	6.06
Vol vs Avg	6.9x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
23% surge on 7x volume, likely driven by contract win, price increase announcement, or short squeeze. Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings Oct 27 where margin expansion from pricing or volume growth can validate the move and drive re-rating.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Clearwater Paper manufactures private-label tissue and paperboard products for retail and commercial customers. The company competes in commodity-exposed end-markets but has been working to improve mix toward higher-margin specialty grades and long-term supply contracts.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to consumer staples demand (defensive), packaging trends, and potential pricing power in a consolidated paper industry. The 23% move suggests either a major contract win or the market pricing in margin inflection from recent price increases sticking.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$21.00 on vol >6x 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 6.9x on a microcap (\$350M) is significant institutional activity. However, RS line NOT at new high and prox_52w only 75.3 suggests this is early-stage-not yet confirmed leadership. The move could be accumulation ahead of Oct earnings, or it could be a squeeze that fades.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 90D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next earnings Oct 27. The 23% move 90 days ahead suggests either leaked alpha (contract win not yet disclosed) or institutional positioning on early margin inflection signals. Oct print will validate or invalidate the thesis.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$19.00 (prior resistance), or on any Q3 guidance signaling pricing pressure, volume loss, or input cost inflation that compresses margins at the Oct 27 print.
ANALYSIS
Strong RS (+63.1 vs SPY) and volume (6.9x), but rs_line_new_high=false and prox_52w 75.3 (not in breakout zone >85) downgrade this from A. Disconfirming evidence: this is a commodity paper company in a structurally challenged industry, and the catalyst for the 23% move is unclear (no news). Without RS line confirmation, this could be a head-fake or squeeze rather than durable institutional accumulation. Oct earnings provide a validation point, but mixed macro caps follow-through. Conviction: Low
Signal: Close above \$21.00 on vol >6x 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 6.9x



Specialty Business Services | Theme: Business Services | 52W Hi: 72% | Base Tight: 8.1 | Vol: 28.84x | RS/SPY: +61.9% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$54.83
Day Change	+17.41%
Mkt Cap	\$2.94B
Float	47M sh
RS vs SPY	+61.9%
52W Hi Prox	72%
Base Tight	8.1
Vol vs Avg	28.84x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Gapping 17% on Q2 earnings today with 29x volume, likely on a beat and FY guidance raise. Forward catalyst: execution on raised guidance over next 90 days, plus potential for M&A announcement (CBIZ has been an active consolidator in accounting/HR services) to extend momentum.

BUSINESS & POSITION

CBIZ provides accounting, tax, advisory, and employee benefits consulting services to middle-market companies. The company has built scale through acquisitions in the fragmented professional services market, leveraging cross-sell and operational efficiencies.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposure to business services consolidation and SMB spending on compliance, tax, and HR outsourcing-defensive, recurring revenue streams. The earnings gap suggests the Street is re-rating the multiple on better-than-expected organic growth or margin expansion.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$54.50 on vol >28x 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 28.84x is extraordinary-massive institutional repositioning after the earnings surprise. However, RS line NOT at new high and prox_52w only 71.5 (well below breakout zone) are yellow flags. This is a catch-up gap after lagging, not a leadership breakout.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS TODAY

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Reported today (Jul 29). The 17% gap on 29x volume confirms a major beat and/or guidance raise that was not in consensus, likely driven by organic revenue growth or M&A contribution beating expectations.

KEY RISK

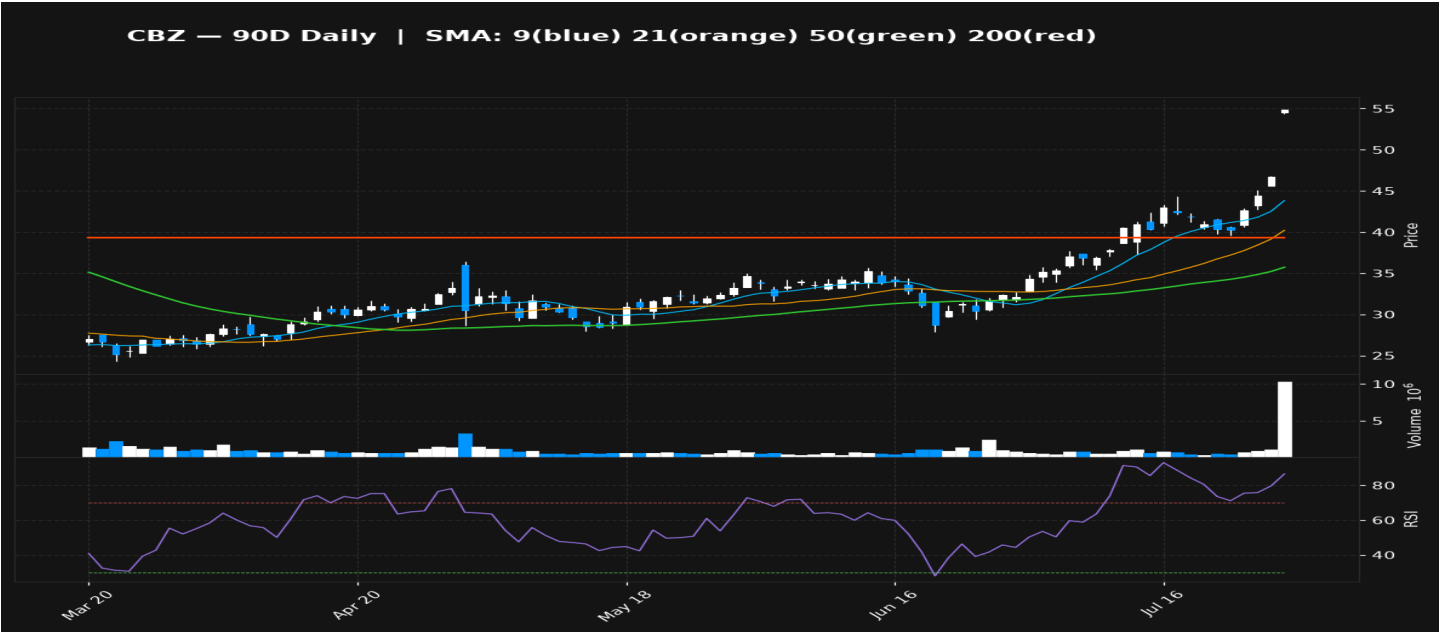
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$52.00 (gap support), or on any FY guidance commentary signaling client budget cuts or M&A integration challenges within 90 days.

ANALYSIS

Massive volume (28.84x) and strong RS (+61.9%), but rs_line_new_high=false and prox_52w 71.5 (not in breakout zone) prevent an A grade. Disconfirming evidence: base_tight 8.1 is very wide, and the stock was NOT in institutional accumulation ahead of the print (RS line not at new high). This is a one-day event-driven gap, not a sustained setup. Earnings already reported, so the catalyst is behind; forward drivers are incremental. Mixed macro regime further caps upside. Conviction: Low

Signal: Close above \$54.50 on vol >28x 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 28.84x



ABG

Asbury Automotive Group Inc

\$252.60

+4.82%

RS vs SPY: +22.0%

B STRONG SETUP

\$4.7B Cap | 17M Float

Auto & Truck Dealerships | Theme: Auto Dealerships | 52W Hi: 96% | Base Tight: 4.99 | Vol: 2.66x | RS/SPY: +22.0% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$252.60
Day Change	+4.82%
Mkt Cap	\$4.70B
Float	17M sh
RS vs SPY	+22.0%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	4.99
Vol vs Avg	2.66x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Tight breakout to near 52W high on 2.7x volume, likely following LAD's strong earnings this morning (sector sympathy). Forward catalyst: Q3 earnings Oct 27 where ABG can validate the sector strength thesis with its own beat-and-raise on used vehicle margins or finance penetration.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Asbury Automotive is the fourth-largest automotive retailer in the U.S., operating 150+ dealerships across new and used vehicle sales, financing, and service. Like LAD, Asbury is executing M&A consolidation in the fragmented dealership sector.

FACTOR & THEME

Same as LAD-auto retail consolidation, consumer credit availability, EV transition. The sector sympathy breakout (ABG following LAD's 18% gap) suggests funds are rotating into the entire dealership group on the thesis that margins and same-store sales are sustainable.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$252.00 on vol >2.6x 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 2.66x on a sector sympathy move, with prox_52w 95.9 and base_tight 4.99-solid but not exceptional. RS line NOT at new high is the key downgrade signal: this is follow-the-leader, not leadership. Funds may be using ABG as a cheaper proxy for LAD, but conviction is lower.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 90D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next earnings Oct 27. The breakout ahead of ABG's own print suggests either positioning on the sector thesis (LAD's beat extrapolates to ABG), or early signals of strong July same-store sales trends that will show up in Q3.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$245.00 (prior pivot), or on any Q3 guidance at Oct 27 signaling margin compression, inventory challenges, or consumer credit stress that diverges negatively from LAD's results.

ANALYSIS

Proximity 95.9 and base_tight 4.99 are strong, but rs_line_new_high=false and rs_vs_spy +22.0 (modest) downgrade from A. Disconfirming evidence: this is sector sympathy, not company-specific strength-ABG is riding LAD's coattails. Without its own catalyst (earnings 90d away), follow-through depends on sustained sector momentum, which is uncertain in a mixed macro regime. Technically sound, but conviction is capped by lack of leadership confirmation. Conviction: Medium

Signal: Close above \$252.00 on vol >2.6x 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.66x

